

DigitalPaani

# Hiring SOP

## Standard Operating Procedure for Hiring in the Hiring Management System (HMS)

For every HR/Admin, Hiring Manager, Leadership, and Super Admin user of HMS

*Version 2.1 · September 2026*

*Supersedes Hiring SOP v2.0 and v1.0 (pre-HMS) · Owner: Founders Office*

## 1. Purpose & Principles

Every hire should happen on time, at the right quality, with no confusion over who owns what. This SOP defines how hiring works end to end now that the entire process — requisitions, sourcing, AI-assisted screening, interviews, offers, and closure — runs through the Hiring Management System (HMS).

HR and the Hiring Manager share ownership of the outcome — a successful, on-time hire. HR owns the process: sourcing, coordination, candidate experience, offer logistics. The Hiring Manager owns the accountability: who gets hired, making sure their own role doesn't stall, and ensuring that the right person gets hired — since their team carries the cost of an open seat. Neither can point at the other if a role runs late — and both must hold each other accountable for lags anywhere in the process.

### Before requesting a hire: fix the workflow first

Most performance gaps are process problems, not headcount problems. Before raising a new requisition, spend time with the team, observe how work actually gets done end to end, and fix friction and tool misuse first. Request a hire only once the team's current process is genuinely optimized — not as a default reaction to feeling behind.

### Guiding principles

1. **One shared goal.** Fill roles with the right talent, on time — not just filled.
2. **One system of record.** HMS is the only tracker. No parallel spreadsheets, no shadow trackers.
3. **A single, named owner at every stage,** with a support role always assigned — Section 3.
4. **Every stage has a defined SLA,** and HMS flags a breach automatically the moment it happens — Section 4. Nobody tracks this by hand.
5. **Delays are visible, not hidden.** The Dashboard, My Tasks, and a daily digest email surface every open item automatically, every day.

## 2. Personas & Their Place in Hiring

HMS has four personas. Full detail on what each can see and do is in the User Access Guide (§ 3, § 5) — this SOP focuses on what's expected of each, not the UI mechanics.

| Persona        | Maps to v1.0 SOP                          | Core responsibility in hiring                                                                                                                   |
|----------------|-------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| HR / Admin     | "HR"                                      | Owns the process: sourcing, screening coordination, scheduling, offers, closure. Full pipeline access.                                          |
| Hiring Manager | "Hiring Manager"                          | Owns the decision: defines the role, reviews AI-scored candidates, interviews, decides who's hired. Accountable for their role closing on time. |
| Leadership     | "Head of People / CEO" (escalation layer) | Approves roles, resolves escalations and Founder Review flags, reviews aging/off-track roles weekly.                                            |
| Super Admin    | (new — HMS only)                          | Owns system access — adding/removing users. Exactly one person, currently Aaron Newton.                                                         |

### 3. The Hiring Workflow, Stage by Stage

Every hire moves through the same sequence. “Accountable” is who answers for that stage. Full click-by-click steps for any action below are in the User Access Guide § 4.

| Task                                 | Stage                                                                          | Accountable                                    | What happens in HMS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | SLA                                                                                                      |
|--------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1. Role Definition & Approval        | —                                                                              | Hiring Manager                                 | HM requests a role on the system or via the Google Form (or creates it directly with HR) with must-haves, nice-to-haves, comp band, and a realistic Close Target. HR/Leadership/Super Admin reviews and approves — a Hiring Manager can never approve their own role.                                                                                                                                               | Approved within 48h of submission                                                                        |
| 2. JD Generation & Sourcing Plan     | —                                                                              | HR                                             | The instant a role is Approved, HMS auto-generates a long-form JD and a social-sharable graphic (~20–30 sec) under Links & Assets. HR posts across the agreed channels and moves the role to Live – Sourcing. Candidates are added directly, via the Job Application Form, or bulk-imported — the moment an application is created, ResumeIQ reads the actual resume and scores it on 8 dimensions, no manual step. | Live within 24h of approval                                                                              |
| 3. Review & Shortlist                | Applied & Screened                                                             | Hiring Manager                                 | Reviewed via My Tasks → Ready for Review. Shortlist advances the candidate straight to Interview Round 1; Hold for Future parks them in Talent Pool; Reject requires a reason.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | 48h (general candidates); 24h (score ≥75)                                                                |
| 4. Interviews (Rounds 1/2, Founders) | Interview 1, Interview 2, Founders Interview (can be clubbed with Interview 2) | HR for scheduling; Hiring Manager for feedback | HR schedules each round (auto-sends a calendar invite); the listed interviewer submits structured feedback. A genuinely positive result (score > 3/5) auto-advances the candidate.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | Scheduled within 48h (24h if score ≥75); feedback within 48h of the interview (24h if score ≥75)         |
| 5. Take-Home Assignment (if used)    | Assignment                                                                     | HR for scheduling; Hiring Manager for feedback | “Send Assignment” creates the round and emails the candidate in one action. HM grades on 5 weighted criteria once submitted.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | Sent within 48h of entering the stage (24h if score ≥75); graded within 96h of the assignment being sent |
| 6. Reference Check                   | Reference Check                                                                | HR                                             | At least two references and call notes (name, relationship, rating) must be logged before the candidate can leave this stage.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | Call notes logged within 24h of entering the stage (1 required minimum to advance)                       |
| 7. Offer & Rollout                   | Pre-Joining, Offer Discussion, Offer Released, Offer Accepted                  | HR                                             | Offer Discussion → Offer Released → Offer Accepted, tracked as pipeline stages.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | Offer released within 24h of the hiring decision                                                         |
| 8. Keeping Warm & Joining            | Offer Accepted → Joined                                                        | HR                                             | Pre-Joining Documents stage; log HR contact regularly. HMS auto-flags “Joining risk” if no contact is logged for 5+ days after Offer Accepted.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | HR contact logged regularly to keep the candidate warm until Joined                                      |
| 9. Role Closure                      | —                                                                              | HR + Hiring Manager                            | Status set to Closed – Filled/Cancelled; a one-page Closure Summary PDF becomes available, covering the whole pipeline history.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | Closed in HMS within 24h of joining/cancellation                                                         |

## 4. SLA Reference — the Numbers to Hold Each Other To

These thresholds are enforced automatically by HMS — a breach appears on the Dashboard's SLA Breaches card, the Hiring Funnel Snapshot, and the responsible person's My Tasks the moment it happens. Nobody needs to track this by hand; use these tables as the shared reference for what "on time" means.

### 4.1 Role aging (by Priority) — anchored to Close Target

Measured in days past a role's Close Target once it's Approved or Live – Sourcing (a role with no Close Target set falls back to counting from its Open Date instead). Pushing the Close Target out genuinely clears the alert — keep it honest.

| Priority (target)                   | Yellow (at risk)    | Red (overdue)       |
|-------------------------------------|---------------------|---------------------|
| P0 — emergency hire (15-day target) | 10 days past target | 23 days past target |
| P1 (30-day target)                  | 15 days past target | 45 days past target |
| P2 (45-day target)                  | 30 days past target | 68 days past target |
| P3 — least urgent (60-day target)   | 30 days past target | 90 days past target |

### 4.2 Escalation Rules

1. HR hasn't sourced the required volume for 5+ working days → the Hiring Manager steps in directly (referrals, personal outreach, an external recruiter) rather than waiting.
2. A Hiring Manager hasn't submitted interview feedback within 24h/48h (as per candidate score) → HMS flags it automatically as part of the SLA; if still open after 96h, HMS additionally flags it to Leadership.
3. A role turns red (past its Close Target aging threshold — § 4.1) → requires discussion for de-bottlenecking at the next Weekly Hiring Sync, not just a note.
4. A role stays unfilled 45+ days past its original Close Target → joint review with Leadership: revise the plan, change the approach, or put it On Hold.
5. Any role with fewer than 5 people shortlisted is flagged in Low Pipeline Roles.
6. Any role with fewer than 3 people who have been shortlisted AND scored above 60 is also flagged in Low Pipeline Roles.

### 4.3 Hard rules — no exceptions

- **Over-budget shortlist:** expected CTC  $\geq 15\%$  over the role's CTC band requires a documented reason before a candidate can be shortlisted into Interview Round 1.
- **Rejection / Withdrawal:** always requires a reason category — no way to do either without one.
- **Reference Check gate:** at least one reference must be on file before a candidate can leave that stage.
- **Feedback gate:** a candidate cannot advance while any of their scheduled rounds still has feedback outstanding.

## 5. Responsibilities & SLA Commitments, by Persona

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### 5.1 HR / Admin

You run the engine room of the pipeline. You are expected to:

- Create/approve role requisitions and confirm JD generation completed (§ 3, stage 1–2).
- Post and source across every agreed channel within 1 working day of approval.
- Source and screen at least 5 qualified candidates per week for every open P0/P1 role.
- Clear the Applied and Screened shortlist queue within 48h — every day it sits open is a day lost.
- Schedule every interview round and send assignments within 48h of a candidate entering that stage.
- Log at least one reference and keep HR contact current through to joining — never 5+ days silent post-Offer Accepted.
- Check the Dashboard daily for red SLA breaches and aging roles — this is not optional, it is the job.
- Bring every off-track role to the Weekly Hiring Sync with a plan, not just a status update.

### 5.2 Hiring Manager

Your job is the decision — and making sure your own role doesn't stall. You are expected to:

- Define the role precisely at request time: must-haves, nice-to-haves, comp band, and a realistic Close Target — HR can only source against something concrete.
- Review AI-scored candidates via My Tasks or Scorecard Summary and decide — shortlist, hold, or reject is your call, not HR's.
- Submit structured interview feedback within 48h of every round or assignment you're listed on — this is the single most common bottleneck in the whole pipeline, and it is on you.
- Escalate to HR — don't just wait — if sourcing volume or screening pace falls behind.
- Attend the Weekly Hiring Sync whenever your role is off-track.

### 5.3 Leadership

You see and do everything HR/Admin does, plus:

- Approve roles — the one action a Hiring Manager can never take.
- Review Aging Roles and the Hiring Funnel Snapshot for oversight across every open role, weekly.
- Resolve Founder Review flags — candidates escalated for your specific attention, outside the normal shortlist flow.
- Chair or attend the Weekly Hiring Sync, and call a joint review when § 4.2 requires one.

### 5.4 Weekly Hiring Sync (60 min)

- HR and Mansi review the Dashboard (Aging Roles, SLA Breaches, Hiring Funnel Snapshot) before the meeting — this is the meeting's actual agenda, not separate prep.
- Any Hiring Manager whose role is currently yellow or red is expected to attend.
- Every off-track item leaves with a named owner and a next action.

## 6. Where to Go for More

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This document covers what's expected and by when. For exactly how to do any of it inside HMS, screen by screen, see the Full User Access Guide — available in-app under Help & FAQ. The Help & FAQ page also answers the most common day-to-day questions directly.

**This SOP is a living document.** If HMS's workflow ever changes in a way that makes something here inaccurate, flag it to the Founders Office rather than quietly working around it.